Year 7 Admission Assessment

Version 2, October 2026

Name	
Date	

Welcome

These activities help us get to know you.

Do your best. It is fine if you cannot answer every question.

- **Read** each question carefully.
- In **Maths** and **Science**, you can ask your teacher to read a question to you.
- In **Listening**, **Reading** and **Writing**, your teacher cannot explain words. We want to see your English.
- You need a pencil, a rubber and a ruler. You cannot use a calculator.

How to answer

Tick a box.

Which one is a city?

- ☐ apple
- ☑ Shanghai
- ☐ green

Write in a box.

7 + 5 = 12

Show your working.

25 × 12

Working

25 × 10 = 250

25 × 2 = 50

Answer 300

The parts of this paper

Part	What you do	Time
Listening	Listen to a message and a talk. Answer 16 questions.	about 12 minutes
Reading	Read three texts. Answer the questions.	15 minutes
Writing	Choose one task. Write about 20 lines.	10 minutes
Break	Have a short rest.	5 minutes
Maths	Answer the questions in Section A, Section B and Section C.	25 minutes
Science	Answer 6 questions.	8 minutes
Talk	Read some sentences aloud. Talk with a teacher about yourself and your plans.	15 minutes

Listening

Part A: A phone message

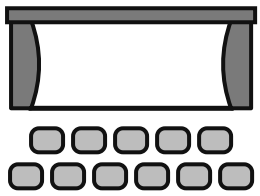
Your teacher will read a phone message **two times**. Li Na is calling her friend Sofia about Saturday.

Read the questions now. Then **listen** and **answer** the questions.

1 / 1

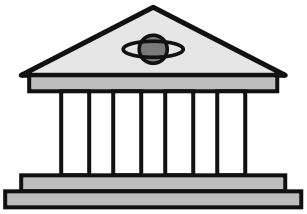
Where are Li Na and Sofia going on Saturday? **Tick** one box.

A



cinema ☐

B



science museum ☐

C

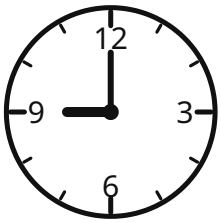


shopping centre ☐

2 / 1

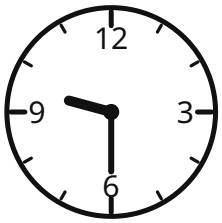
What time will they meet? **Tick** one box.

A



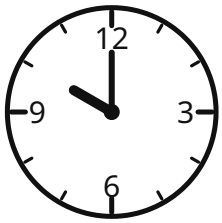
9:00 ☐

B



9:30 ☐

C

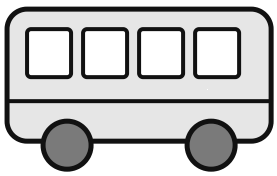


10:00 ☐

3 / 1

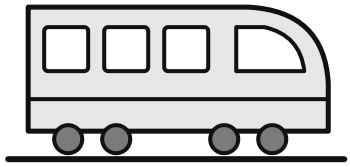
How will Sofia travel to the museum? **Tick** one box.

A



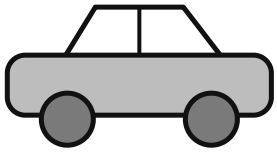
bus ☐

B



metro ☐

C



car ☐

4 / 1

What must Sofia bring? **Tick** two boxes.

☐ a student card ☐ an umbrella ☐ a packed lunch

☐ a camera ☐ money for the café

5 / 1

Which metro exit should Sofia use? **Write** the number in the box.

Exit ☐

6 / 1

How much will Sofia pay for her ticket? **Write** the number in the box.

☐ yuan

7 / 1

Li Na says, "Please don't be late." Why? **Write** your answer.

8 / 1

Li Na tells Sofia about her brother. Why? **Write** your answer.

Part B: A short talk

Your teacher will read a short talk **two times**. A science teacher is giving a lesson about deserts.

You have one minute to **read** questions 9 to 16. Then **listen** and **answer** the questions.

9 / 1

A desert gets less than how much rain or snow in a year? **Write** the number in the box.

less than [ ] millimetres

10 / 1

Which is the largest desert in the world? **Tick** one box.

☐ the Sahara ☐ Antarctica ☐ the Namib

11 / 1

The roots of a cactus spread out just below the surface of the ground. Why is this useful for the cactus? **Use** what the teacher says about rain. **Write** your answer.

12 and 13 / 2

Complete the notes. **Write** one, two or three words in each box.

Many desert animals are nocturnal. They look for food at [night]

Notes: desert animals

12 The fennec fox's big ears help it to lose [ ]

13 A camel's hump is full of [ ]

14 / 1

How does the beetle in the Namib Desert get water? **Write** the numbers 1, 2, 3 and 4 in the boxes to show the order.

[2] I eat breakfast. [1] I get up. [3] I go to school.

Order	What the beetle does
[ ]	Drops of water collect on its back.
[ ]	It climbs to the top of a sand dune.
[ ]	The water rolls down into its mouth.
[ ]	It leans forward into the wind.

15 / 1

At the end, the teacher talks about people who say a desert is an empty place. What does she think about these people? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ They are right. Very few things live in a desert.
- ☐ They have not looked carefully enough.
- ☐ They know more about deserts than scientists do.

16 / 1

What is the talk mostly about? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ why deserts are always hot and sandy
- ☐ how plants and animals survive with very little water
- ☐ why camels are the most important desert animals

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Reading

Read the texts and **answer** the questions.

Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish.

You have 15 minutes.

Part A: A notice

Read the notice. Then **answer** questions 1 to 6.

After-school clubs

Autumn term

All clubs: 4:15 pm to 5:30 pm

	Club	Day	Where
	**Basketball**	Monday and Thursday	Sports hall
	**Chess**	Tuesday	Library
	**Robotics**	Wednesday	Room 14
	**Drama**	Thursday	Hall
	**Art**	Friday	Room 9

Basketball: bring a water bottle.

Robotics: 50 yuan for the term.

To join: write your name on the list outside the school office by 12 September.

1 / 1

Which day is the Chess Club? **Write** your answer in the box.

2 / 1

Where does the Robotics Club meet? **Write** your answer in the box.

3 / 1

What time do the clubs finish? **Write** your answer in the box.

4 / 1

Which club meets two times every week? **Write** your answer in the box.

5 / 3

Tick True or False for each sentence.

Example	True	False
The Art Club meets on Friday.	✓	

Sentence	True	False
a. The Drama Club meets in the library.	☐	☐
b. The Robotics Club costs 50 yuan.	☐	☐
c. You need a water bottle for the Chess Club.	☐	☐

6 / 1

Aisha loves acting and performing. Which club is best for her? **Write** your answer in the box.

Part B: A story

Read the story. Then **answer** questions 7 to 13.

Mist

On his first morning at Riverside Middle School, Chen Yu stood at the classroom door and counted the faces. Thirty-one. Nobody looked up.

"You can sit next to Tom," said Ms Wang, pointing to an empty desk by the window. Tom was drawing something in the back of his maths book. He moved his pencil case to make space, but he did not say a word.

All morning, Chen Yu kept his eyes on the board. He copied down every word, even the ones he did not need. At lunch, he sat at the end of a long table and ate his rice very slowly, so that he would always look busy.

In the afternoon, rain began to stream down the windows. The class had art, and Ms Wang asked everyone to draw a place they loved. Chen Yu thought of his grandfather's tea garden in the hills outside Hangzhou: the neat rows of green bushes, the narrow stone steps, the white mist that hung over everything in the early morning. He drew until the bell rang.

"That's the best one in the room," said a voice. Tom was leaning over his shoulder. "How did you do the mist?"

Chen Yu showed him. You press lightly with the side of the pencil, then rub it gently with your finger. Tom tried it on the corner of his own page. His mist looked more like smoke from a factory chimney, and they both laughed.

"Do you want to come to art club tomorrow?" Tom asked. "We meet in the art room after lunch. It's mostly people who are bad at football."

Chen Yu was terrible at football. "Yes," he said. "I'd like that."

On the bus home, he watched the grey streets go past. Somehow, they did not look quite so grey any more.

7 / 1

Where did Ms Wang ask Chen Yu to sit? **Write** your answer.

8 / 1

What did Ms Wang ask the class to draw? **Write** your answer.

9 / 1

At lunch, Chen Yu ate his rice very slowly "so that he would always look busy". Why did he want to look busy? **Write** your answer.

10 / 1

"Rain began to **stream** down the windows." What does **stream** mean here? **Tick** one box.

☐ fall a little at a time ☐ flow fast, like a river ☐ stop suddenly

11 / 2

How did Chen Yu feel on his first morning? **Write** one word. Then **write** one thing from the story that shows this.

He felt ☐

This shows it:

12 / 1

Tom says that the art club is "mostly people who are bad at football". Why do you think he says this? **Write** your answer.

13 / 1

Look at the last sentence of the story. Why do you think the writer says the streets "did not look quite so grey any more"? **Write** your answer.

Part C: A harder story

Part C is hard. Do as much as you can.

Read the story. Then **answer** questions 14 to 20.

The Long Black Case

It was Lin who first noticed Mr Gao, and it was Lin who decided that he was a spy.

The evidence, she insisted, was overwhelming. He had moved into the flat at the end of our corridor in the middle of the night, with no furniture that anyone could see. He never left the building before sunset, and he crept home at dawn, grey-faced and yawning, as though he had spent the night doing something that could not be done in daylight. Worst of all, he owned a long black case, almost as tall as I was, which he carried in both arms, as tenderly as if it were a newborn baby.

"Nobody needs a case like that," Lin whispered, "unless they have something to hide."

I was not entirely convinced. Still, I was eleven, and a spy on the thirtieth floor was far more thrilling than the maths homework that waited for me every evening. So, for three weeks, we became detectives. We timed his footsteps past our door. We pressed our ears to the wall. Lin kept a notebook in which she recorded every suspicious act in small, ferocious handwriting: *8:47 pm. Subject leaves with case. Subject is humming.*

"Humming," she said darkly, "is exactly what a spy would do."

By the end of the second week, she had four different theories about who he was working for, each one more elaborate than the last.

Then, on the last Saturday of the holidays, Mr Gao did something new. Instead of waiting for the lift, he took the stairs: not down, towards the street, but up, towards the roof garden, where nobody went after dark. Lin's eyes widened. Without a word, we followed, our hearts thudding louder than our footsteps.

The door at the top had been propped open with a brick. Beyond it, the city glittered in every direction, a restless sea of windows and headlights that stretched all the way to the hills. In the middle of the roof stood Mr Gao. The case lay open at his feet, and rising out of it, on three thin legs, was a telescope.

He did not seem surprised to see us. If anything, he looked pleased.

"Ah," he said. "The two who write everything down. Come and see what I have been hiding."

I put my eye to the cold metal. At first there was only blackness. Then he turned a small wheel, and a tiny, pale ball drifted into view, circled by a ring so thin and so perfect that it hardly seemed real. I had seen it in a hundred photographs, but never like this: the real thing, hanging in the darkness above our ordinary building.

"Saturn," said Mr Gao. "More than a billion kilometres away. People say there is nothing to see from the city, because the lights are too bright. They are wrong. You just have to be patient, and remember to look up."

Lin said nothing. For once, she did not write anything down either.

We stayed until the windows in the towers began to go dark, one by one. When we finally went back downstairs, Lin tore the pages out of her notebook, folded them into a tight square and dropped them into the bin beside the lift. She did not explain, and I did not ask.

The next evening, at 8:47, we were waiting by the door to the roof.

14 / 1

"The evidence, she insisted, was **overwhelming**." What does **overwhelming** mean here? **Tick** one box.

- [ ] very strong, so it is hard to argue with
- [ ] very small, so it is easy to miss
- [ ] very old, so it is hard to check

15 / 1

Why does Lin think that Mr Gao is a spy? **Explain** two reasons in your own words.

Reason 1:

Reason 2:

16 / 1

"Humming," Lin says darkly, "is exactly what a spy would do." What do you think the writer wants us to think about Lin's evidence? **Explain** your answer.

17 / 1

On the roof, Mr Gao "did not seem surprised to see us". What does this suggest? **Write** your answer. Then **write** the words from the story that show this.

This suggests that:

The words that show this:

18 / 1

Why do you think Lin tore the pages out of her notebook? **Write** your answer. Then **write** the words from the story that show this.

I think that:

The words that show this:

19 / 1

The story ends: "The next evening, at **8:47**, we were waiting by the door to the roof." Why do you think the writer chose the time 8:47? **Explain** your answer.

20 / 2

Summarise how the children's feelings about Mr Gao change during the story. **Write** two or three sentences in your own words.

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Writing

You have 10 minutes.

Choose one task. **Tick** the box for your task.

☐ **Task 1: A story**	☐ **Task 2: Your opinion**
Write a story that begins: "*When Mei opened the box, she could not believe her eyes.*"	"*The school summer holiday should be shorter.*" Do you agree? **Write** your opinion.
Ideas: What was in the box? What happened next? How did the story end?	Ideas: Give reasons and examples. What do other people think?

Plan your writing in the box. You can write notes.

Plan

Write your answer on the lines. Try to write about 20 lines.

Check your writing: capital letters, full stops, spelling. Does it make sense?

Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Maths

You have 25 minutes. You cannot use a calculator.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

Show your working. You can get marks for your working.

Section A: Fluency

Work out the answers. **Write** each answer in the box.

1 / 2

a. $2\frac{3}{4} + 1\frac{5}{6} =$ ☐

b. $1\frac{3}{5} \div 2\frac{2}{3} =$ ☐

Working

2 / 1

$4.8 \div 0.06 =$ ☐

3 / 1

$3 \times (2 + 4)^2 - 4^3 \div 8 =$ ☐

4 / 1

$(-3)^2 - 5 \times (-2) =$ ☐

5 / 1

17.5% of 240 = ☐

6 / 1

Simplify $3(2x - 5) - 4x$

☐

7 / 1

$a = -3$ and $b = 4$.

Work out the value of $a^2 - 2ab$

☐

8 / 1

Solve $6 - 4x = 20$

$x =$ ☐

9 / 1

Here are the first four terms of a sequence.

23, 20, 17, 14, ...

Write an expression for the nth term.

☐

Section B: Word questions

Read each question carefully. **Write** an equation, then **solve** it. **Show** your working.

Example. I think of a number. I multiply it by 4. Then I subtract 7. The answer is 25. What is my number?

Write an equation. Call my number n. $4n - 7 = 25$

Solve it. $4n = 32$, so $n = 8$. **Check:** $4 \times 8 - 7 = 25$. My number is **8**.

10 / 2

I think of a number. I add 6 to it. Then I multiply the answer by 3. The result is 51.

What is my number?

Working

My number is ☐

11 / 2

A pen costs ¥2.50 more than a pencil.

3 pens and 2 pencils cost ¥17.50 altogether.

How much does one pencil cost?

Working

One pencil costs ¥ ☐

12 / 2

The length of a rectangle is 5 cm more than its width.

The perimeter of the rectangle is 46 cm.

Work out the area of the rectangle.

Working

[ ] cm^2

13 / 2

Amir is 3 times as old as his sister Aisha.

5 years from now, Amir will be 2 times as old as Aisha.

How old is Amir now?

Working

Amir is [ ] years old.

Section C: Applied problems

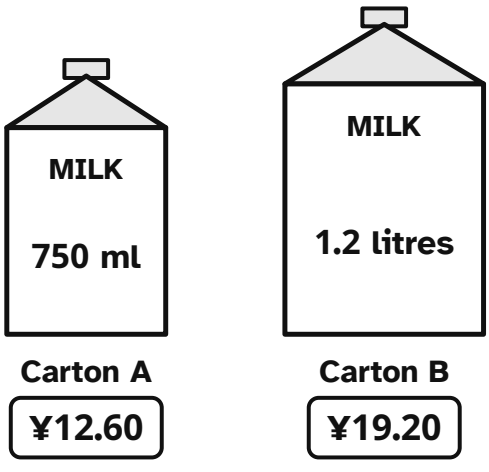
14 / 2

A shop sells milk in two sizes.

Which carton is better value for money? **Show** how you decide.

Working

Carton [ ] is better value.



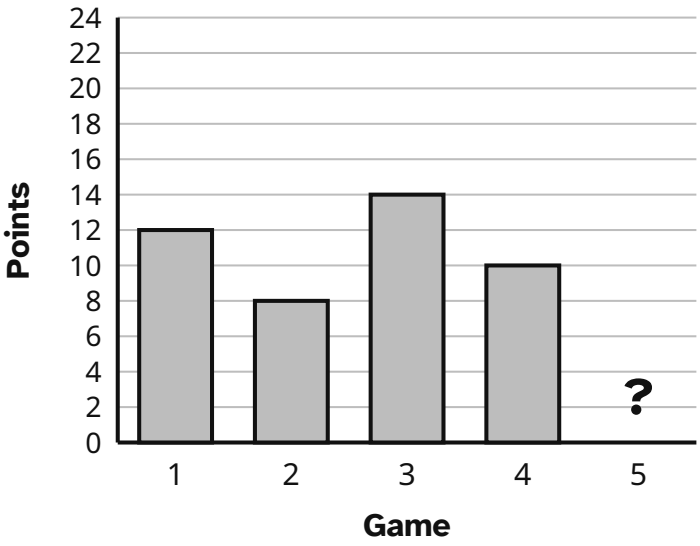
15

/ 2

Zhang Wei plays basketball. The bar chart shows his points in games 1 to 4.

Then he plays game 5. His mean for the 5 games is 2 points more than his mean for games 1 to 4.

How many points did he score in game 5?



Working

[ ] points

16

/ 3

The diagram shows a folding stool from the side.

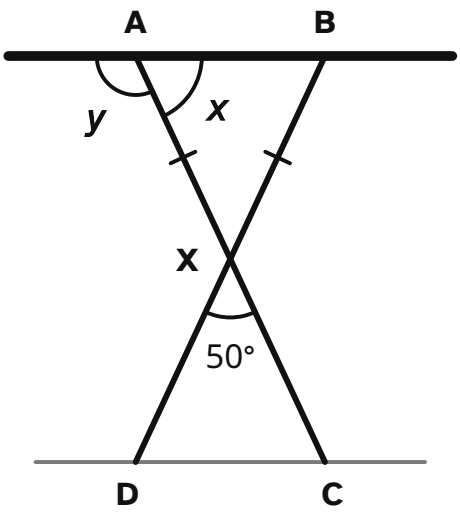
The legs AC and BD are straight. They cross at X.

The seat is a straight line through A and B.

XA = XB. Angle DXC = 50°.

Work out the size of angle *x* and angle *y*.
Give a reason for each answer.

Not drawn accurately



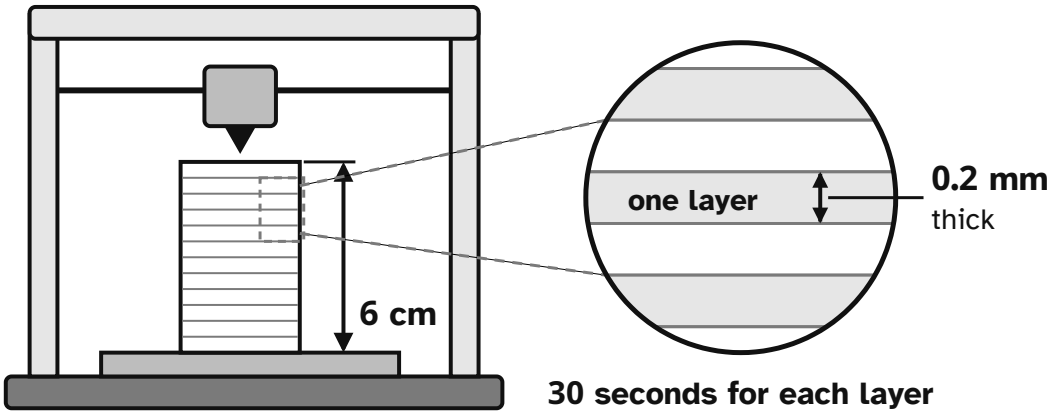
x = [ ] ° Reason:

y = [ ] ° Reason:

17 / 2

A 3D printer makes a model from thin layers of plastic. It prints one layer on top of another.

The model is 6 cm tall. Each layer is 0.2 mm thick. The printer takes 30 seconds to print each layer.



The printer starts printing the model at 09:45.

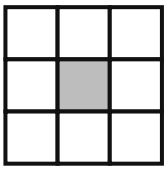
At what time does it finish the model?

Working

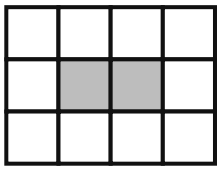
The printer finishes at

18 / 3

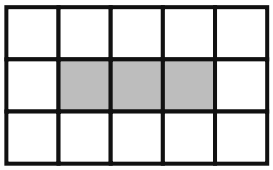
Tom makes garden paths from grey tiles and white tiles.



Pattern 1
1 grey, 8 white



Pattern 2
2 grey, 10 white



Pattern 3
3 grey, 12 white

a. How many white tiles are in Pattern 10? ☐

b. Tom has 51 white tiles and lots of grey tiles. He makes one path that follows the pattern.
What is the largest number of grey tiles his path can have? ☐

Working

c. **Explain** why every pattern has an even number of white tiles.

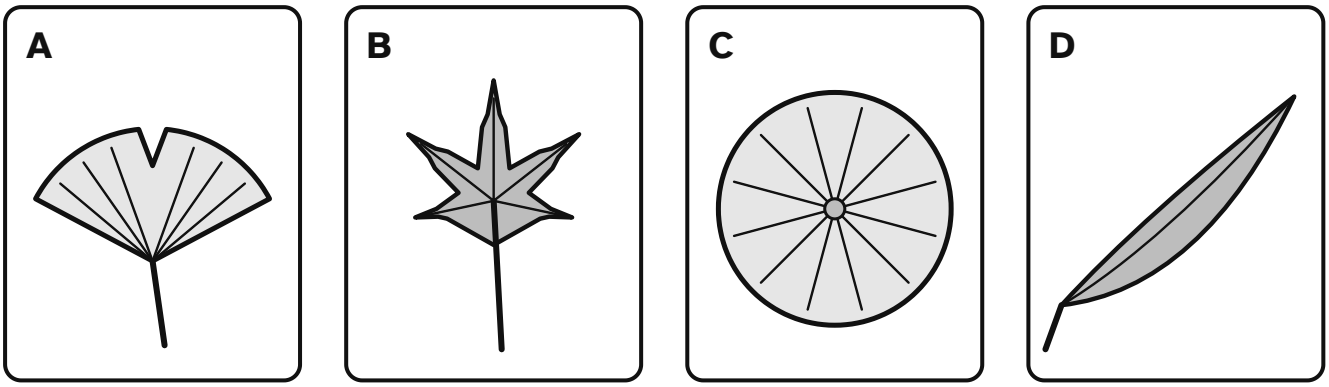
Stop here. Wait for your teacher.

Science

You have 8 minutes.

You can ask your teacher to read a question to you.

1 / 2



Use the key to name each leaf.

	Question	Yes	No
1	Is the leaf long and thin?	bamboo	Go to 2
2	Is the leaf round?	lotus	Go to 3
3	Is the leaf shaped like a fan?	ginkgo	maple

Leaf D is long and thin. Leaf D is **bamboo**.

Write the name of each leaf.

A _____ B _____ C _____

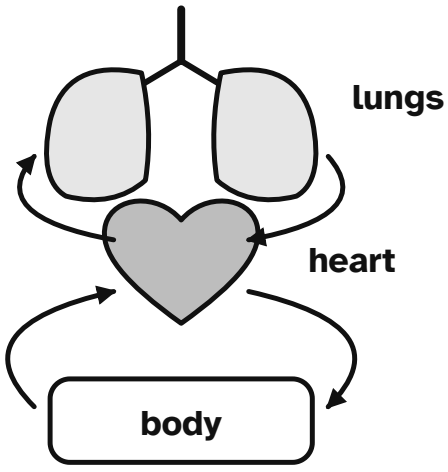
2 / 1

The heart pumps blood to the lungs.

In the lungs, the blood picks up a gas.

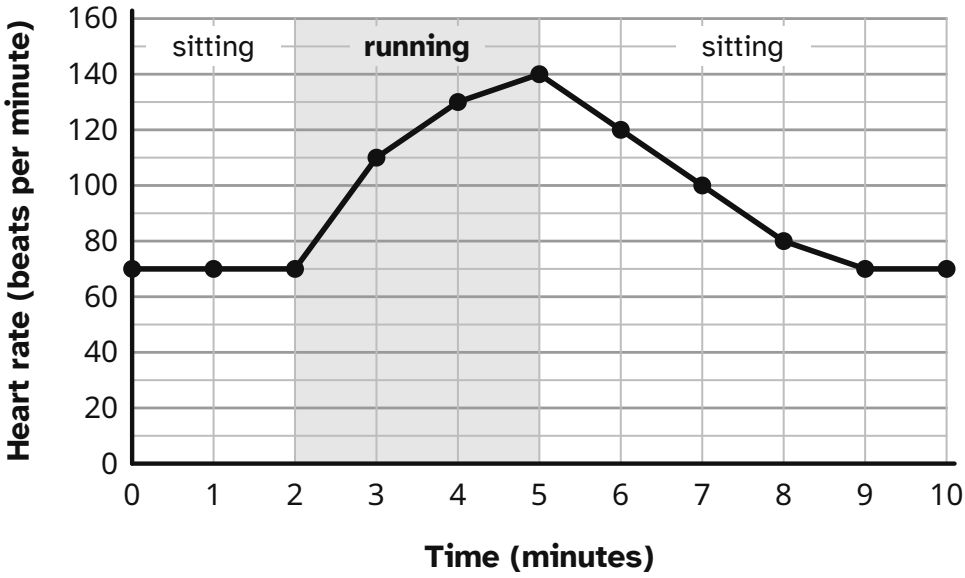
Which gas? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ oxygen
- ☐ carbon dioxide
- ☐ nitrogen



3 / 2

Jun sits, then runs, then sits again. The graph shows his heart rate.

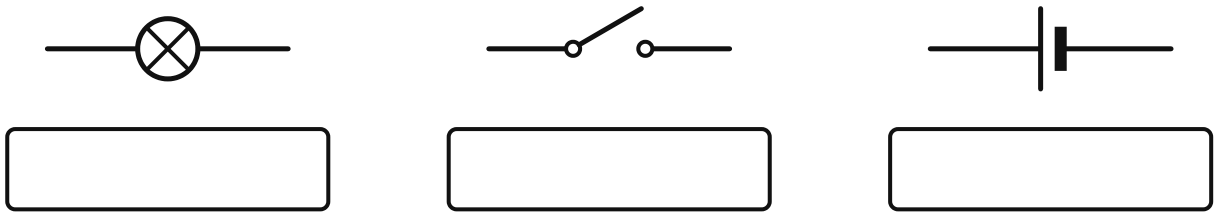


a. What was Jun's heart rate at 4 minutes? ☐ beats per minute

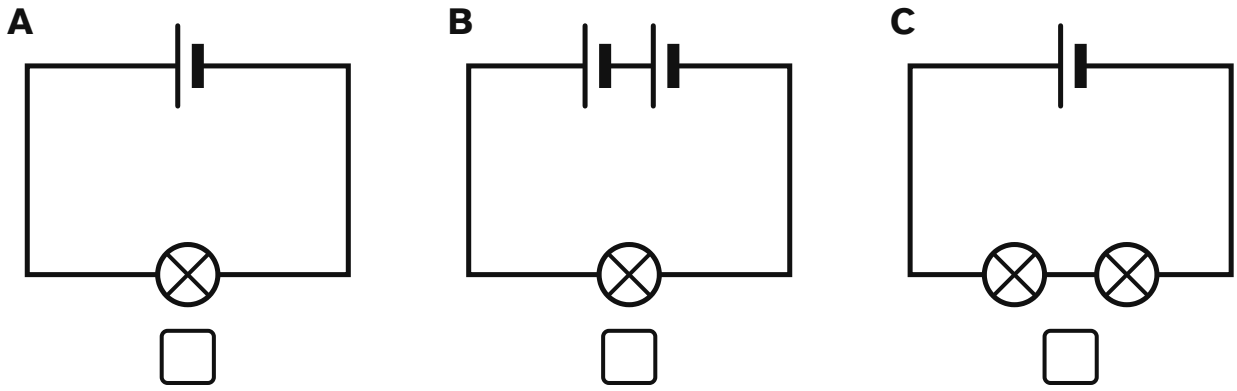
b. Why does Jun's heart beat faster when he runs? **Explain** your answer.

4 / 2

a. **Write** the name of each circuit symbol in the box. Use these words: **bulb**, **cell**, **switch**.



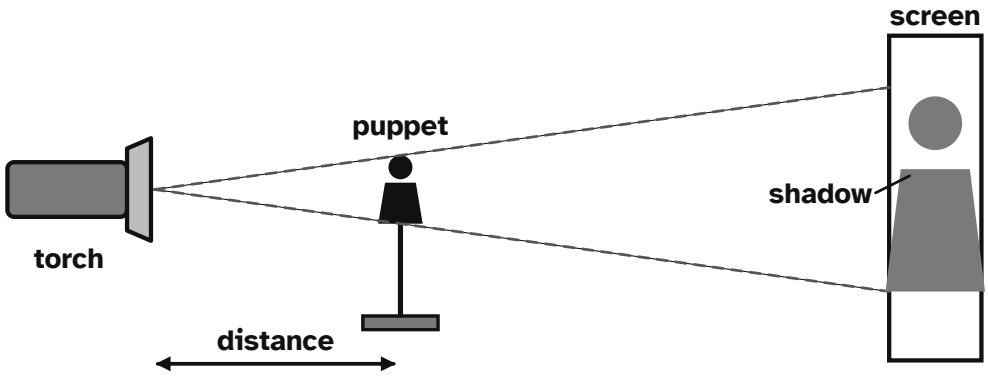
b. In which circuit is the bulb the brightest? **Tick** one box.



5

/ 2

Mei makes a shadow with a torch and a card puppet. She moves the torch. She measures the height of the shadow.



Distance from the torch to the puppet (cm)	10	20	30	40
Height of the shadow (cm)	36	24	20	18

a. Mei wants a fair test. What must she keep the same? **Tick** one box.

- ☐ the distance from the torch to the puppet
- ☐ the puppet she uses
- ☐ the height of the shadow

b. **Complete** the sentence.

When the torch moves further away from the puppet, the shadow gets

_____

6

/ 1

Scientists found fossils of sea animals in rocks near the top of a high mountain.

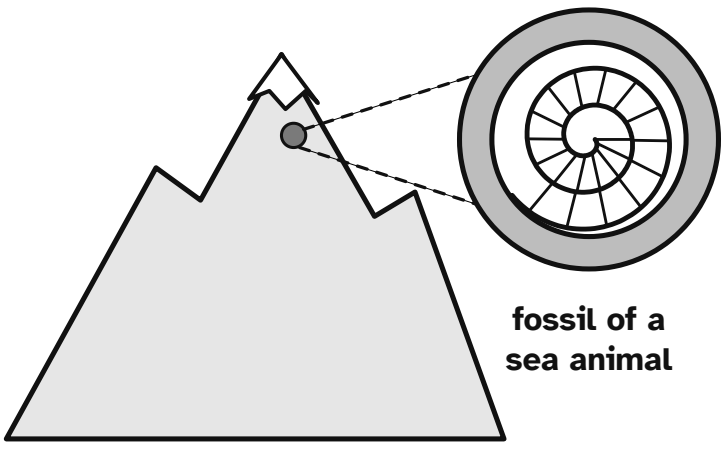
What does this tell us about these rocks a long time ago?

Write your answer.

_____

_____

_____



Thank you. You have finished. Please wait for your teacher.

Year 7 Admission Assessment v2: assessor booklet

Version 2, October 2026. This version replaces version 1 for Year 7 admissions; the version 1 files are kept for reference only. What is new: the listening has a second, academic part (Part B, a short lesson), so it is out of 16; the reading paper has a new, harder Part C (the version 1 Part C is now Part B, and the version 1 Part B is no longer used); and the maths paper is new, aimed at the higher end, with three sub-scores: fluency, word questions and applied problems. Writing, science, the interview and the shared reading files have not changed.

For students applying to join **Year 7** (age 11 to 12 on 1 September). A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 5** and is the same age as a student starting Grade 6. The maths paper starts at the level expected for entry to Year 7 (the end of UK Year 6) and goes well beyond it, so several topics (dividing fractions, powers, negative numbers, percentages, expanding brackets, equations with the unknown on both sides, the nth term, vertically opposite angles) **may not have been taught yet**. Section 4 lists them. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Notes
1	Welcome	2	Assessor	Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler	Script in Section 2
2	Listening (paper pages 2 to 5): Part A, a phone message; Part B, a short talk	about 12	Assessor reads each script twice	This booklet, Section 3.1	Can be done with a small group
3	Reading paper (pages 6 to 12)	15	Student works alone; assessor times	Clock or timer	Do not read the texts aloud
4	Writing (pages 13 to 14)	10	Student works alone		Choose one of two tasks
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths (pages 15 to 20)	25	Student; assessor may read questions aloud	No calculator, no protractor	Section A fluency, Section B word questions, Section C applied problems
7	Science (pages 21 to 23)	8	Student; assessor may read questions aloud		
8	Interview, opening with sentence reading	15	Interviewer, 1:1	`forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, a plain card	Sentence reading starts at **Level 6** (sentence 16)
	Total	**about 90**			Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate)

Print for each candidate: the Year 7 v2 student paper (23 pages, A4), the interview record (Years 7 to 10), the sentence reading record, the parent conversation record and the candidate summary. **Print once per room:** this booklet and the sentence reading card (laminate it). The score summary (Section 6) can be copied, one per candidate.

2. Before you start

Welcome script. Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

Access rules (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts.
Answers	**In English only.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**In English only.** Numbers, ticks, drawings and working count. An answer, reason or explanation written in Chinese scores 0, even after an L reading.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary.

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it in the score summary.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Listening Part B and reading Part C are meant to stretch fluent students: a student who is new to English may follow little of them, and that is expected. In the reading paper, if the student is clearly stuck after Part B, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." In maths, the paper goes well beyond the expected level, so many students will not finish; reassure them. In writing, if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it.
- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 12 minutes, 16 marks)

Two parts, each read twice. **Part A** is everyday listening: the version 1 task, unchanged (questions 1 to 8). **Part B** is academic listening: a short lesson at the level of a science lesson for a fluent student of 11 or 12 (questions 9 to 16). Read Part A, let the student finish, then go straight on to Part B. Reading both scripts twice, with the time to read the questions and to finish, takes about 12 minutes.

Part A: a phone message (questions 1 to 8, 8 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Listening page. This is Part A. I am going to read a phone message. Li Na is calling her friend Sofia. I will read it two times. First, read the questions." Give the student **one minute** to look at questions 1 to 8 (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at a natural, steady pace. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part of the

message, and do not explain any word.

> **Script: a phone message**
>
> Hi Sofia, it's Li Na. I'm calling about our plan for Saturday. **[pause]**
>
> The cinema in Riverside Mall is closed this weekend, so we can't see the film. Let's go to the science museum instead. **[pause]**
>
> We can meet outside the main entrance at half past nine. **[pause]**
>
> The easiest way to get there is by metro. My dad is picking us up at four o'clock, so you don't need to take the metro home. **[pause]**
>
> Please bring your student card, because students get cheaper tickets. And bring a packed lunch. The café in the museum is really expensive, and we can eat in the garden. **[pause]**
>
> On the metro, take Line 2 and get off at Lakeside Station. Then use Exit 4. The museum is right in front of you. **[pause]**
>
> Tickets are usually 40 yuan, but students only pay 25 yuan. **[pause]**
>
> Please don't be late, because the first show in the space theatre starts at ten o'clock. **[pause]**
>
> My brother Jun went to the museum last week. He's fourteen, and he thinks everything is boring. But even he said the robot exhibition was amazing! It closes on Sunday, so this is our last chance to see it. **[pause]**
>
> Please send me a message tonight and tell me if you can come. Bye!

Answers. One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**B** science museum		A (cinema): heard "cinema" but missed "closed". C: heard "Mall".
2	**B** 9:30		C (10:00): heard the time of the show, not the meeting time.
3	**B** metro		C (car): heard "My dad is picking us up", which is for going home.
4	**Both** student card **and** packed lunch		One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Money for the café" is a distractor.
5	**4**	four	2 (the metro line).
6	**25**	25 yuan, ¥25	40 (the usual price): missed "but students only pay".
7	The first show (in the space theatre) starts at ten.	They will miss the show; the show is at 10; they must be there before the show.	"Because they meet at half past nine" with no reason.
8	To show that the robot exhibition must be very good: even her brother, who thinks everything is boring, liked it.	To make Sofia want to come; because the robots are amazing; because it is good and it closes soon.	"Because he is fourteen"; "because he is boring".

Part B: a short talk (questions 9 to 16, 8 marks)

Say: "Now turn to Part B, on page 4. You will hear a short talk. A science teacher is giving a lesson about deserts. I will read it two times. You have one minute to read questions 9 to 16." After **one minute**, say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

Read it twice at a natural classroom pace, as you would explain something to a class of fluent 11 year olds (about 150 words a minute; each reading takes about 2 and a half minutes). Pause for 2 to 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give **one minute** to finish. Do not

slow down to dictation speed, repeat any part, or explain any word: Part B measures whether the student can follow a lesson in English at normal speed.

Script: a short lesson about deserts

Good morning, everyone. Today we are finding out how plants and animals survive in one of the harshest habitats on Earth: the desert. **[pause]**

When you hear the word "desert", you probably imagine golden sand and blazing sunshine. However, scientists define a desert by its precipitation, which means rain or snow, rather than by its temperature. A desert receives less than 250 millimetres of precipitation a year, while Shanghai, by comparison, gets more than a thousand. By this definition, about a third of the land on our planet is desert. The largest is the Sahara, in North Africa. Actually, I need to correct that: the Sahara is the largest hot desert, but the largest desert of all is Antarctica. **[pause]**

Even when rain does come, it usually falls in one short, heavy storm, and much of it evaporates, or turns into water vapour, within a few hours. So how does anything survive? The answer is adaptations: special features that help a living thing to survive in its habitat. **[pause]**

Take the cactus. Most plants lose a lot of water through their leaves. A cactus, on the other hand, has sharp spines instead of leaves, and as a result, far less water escapes into the air. Its thick stem stores water like a tank, while its roots spread out widely, just below the surface. **[pause]**

Many desert animals are nocturnal: they shelter from the heat of the day and look for food at night. The fennec fox has enormous ears, which release heat from its body, whereas the Arctic fox has small ears that keep heat in. Many people think a camel's hump is full of water. In fact, it is full of fat, which the camel can turn into energy when food is scarce. **[pause]**

The most remarkable example, though, is a beetle from the Namib Desert, in south-west Africa. On foggy mornings, it climbs to the top of a sand dune and leans forward into the wind. Tiny drops of water from the fog collect on its back and then roll down into its mouth. **[pause]**

So, next time someone tells you that a desert is an empty place, you might ask them how carefully they have looked.

What the talk contains (measured from the script above): 364 words in 23 sentences, an average of 16 words per sentence. 23% of its words are not among the 2000 most common English words in the `wordfreq` lists; with the method of `02_Listening_Evidence_Statement` (word endings matched, names of places not counted) the figure is about 19%, against 6 to 15% for the version 1 scripts. Features: a process (how the beetle collects water) and cause and effect (spines, so less water escapes); comparisons (a cactus and most plants; the fennec fox and the Arctic fox; desert and Shanghai rainfall); numbers (250 millimetres, more than a thousand, a third, a few hours); subject words explained in passing (precipitation, evaporates, adaptations, habitat, nocturnal); a self-correction ("Actually, I need to correct that"); a misconception corrected ("In fact"); an opinion that is implied, not stated (the last sentence); discourse markers (however, while, by comparison, on the other hand, as a result, whereas, in fact, though).

Answers. One mark each (questions 12 and 13 are one mark per gap). Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Short answers and notes are fine: the writing is not marked here. Answers must be in English. The questions follow the order of the talk; question 16 is about the whole talk.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Specific detail (a number)	**250** (millimetres)	two hundred and fifty	1000 or "a thousand" (Shanghai's rainfall): heard the comparison, not the definition.
10	Specific detail (a name)	**Antarctica**		The Sahara: missed the self-correction ("Actually, I need to correct that: the Sahara is the largest hot desert"). The Namib: caught a later name only.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
11	Inference joining two parts of the talk	Rain does not last long in a desert: it comes in one short storm and much of it evaporates within a few hours, so roots just below the surface can take in the water quickly, before it evaporates.	Any answer that links the roots to the rain disappearing quickly: "to catch the rain fast before it dries up"; "the water evaporates quickly, so the roots must get it quickly"; "the rain only comes for a short time".	"To get water" or "to drink water" with no link to the rain disappearing quickly (a literal answer that does not join the two parts); "to hold the cactus up"; "because it rains a lot".
12	Note completion	**heat**	body heat; heat from its body; the heat; hot air	"water", "sound"; "cold" (mixed up with the Arctic fox's small ears that keep heat in).
13	Note completion	**fat**	fats; fat for energy	"water": the belief the teacher corrects ("Many people think a camel's hump is full of water. In fact, it is full of fat"): heard the first sentence, missed "In fact". "Energy" alone: what the fat becomes, not what fills the hump.
14	Process: a sequence	From the top: **3, 1, 4, 2** (climbs the dune, leans into the wind, drops collect on its back, water rolls into its mouth)		Any other order: 0. All four must be right for the mark. "Leans" before "climbs" usually means the student caught the words but not the order.
15	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**They have not looked carefully enough.**		"They are right": took "an empty place" at face value and missed the meaning of "you might ask them how carefully they have looked".
16	Main idea	**how plants and animals survive with very little water**		"why deserts are always hot and sandy" (the talk says the opposite; caught "sand" and "sunshine" from the opening); "camels" (one detail).

Band guide v2 (listening, / 16). Use the part scores, in this order:

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A**
Part A 3 to 4	**B**
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D**
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example Part A 6 with Part B 6, which can happen when a student misses one picture item but follows the talk well): look at which items were lost, and check against "listening in conversation" on the interview record.

What to look for

- In Part A, questions 1 to 4 each have a distractor. A student who chooses the distractor every time is catching single words ("cinema", "ten", "dad") without the sentence around them: typical of band B. Questions 7 and 8 need inference.
- Part A shows secure everyday listening; Part B shows whether the student can follow a lesson at normal speed. A fluent Year 7 listener answers most of Part B quickly, including questions 11 and 15, which depend on joining ideas rather than catching words.

- Questions 10 and 13 have a strong distractor that is said first and then corrected ("Actually", "In fact"). A student who chooses the Sahara or writes "water" is following word by word and missing how the speaker's ideas connect: typical of band C or low D.
- A student who scores 7 or 8 in Part A but 0 to 2 in Part B copes with everyday English but will find lessons in English hard at first: band C, with listening support planned.
- **English barrier or something else?** If a student scores low but follows your spoken instructions easily, check whether the problem was speed (they may do better in conversation) or attention. Note it for the interview.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 24 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are three parts. They get harder. Part C is hard. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

Mark scheme. Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question, except where a question asks for the student's own words (questions 15 and 20). Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Part A: After-school clubs (a notice; very accessible, with pictures)

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
1	Tuesday	Tue	
2	Room 14	14	Library
3	5:30 pm	5:30, half past five, 17:30	4:15
4	Basketball		
5	a False · b True · c False		1 mark for each correct row (3 marks)
6	Drama	Drama Club	Art

Part B: Mist (fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 11; this was Part C in version 1, with the same questions and answers, renumbered)

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
7	Retrieval	Next to Tom	By the window; at the empty desk by the window	
8	Retrieval	A place they loved	A favourite place; a place they like	His grandfather's tea garden (what Chen Yu drew, not what was asked)
9	Inference	He was alone and did not want people to see it.	He had nobody to talk to; he was shy, nervous or lonely; he did not know anyone; so nobody would notice him	He was hungry; the rice was hot
10	Vocabulary in context	flow fast, like a river		
11	Inference with evidence (2)	**1 mark** for a feeling: nervous, shy, lonely, worried, scared, uncomfortable, sad, alone, not happy. **1 mark** for evidence that fits: he counted the faces; nobody looked up; he kept his eyes on the board; he copied every word; Tom did not say a word; he sat at the end of the table; he ate slowly to look busy.	Evidence in the student's own words	A positive feeling ("happy", "excited") scores 0 for the feeling; the evidence mark can still be given if the evidence is correct.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
12	Why do you think	To make a joke; to make Chen Yu feel welcome or relaxed.	To show the club is friendly and you do not need to be good at sport; because Tom is bad at football too; to make him laugh	"Because they play football in the club"
13	Author's purpose	The grey streets show Chen Yu's feelings: he feels happier or more hopeful now, because he has made a friend.	He is not lonely now; his day got better; things seem better because of Tom and the art club	"Because the rain stopped" (not in the text: a literal reading; note it)

Part C: The Long Black Case (literary fiction, above the level expected at 11 or 12; new in version 2)

571 words. Rich vocabulary (insisted, overwhelming, tenderly, convinced, ferocious, elaborate, propped, glittered), long and varied sentences, figurative language ("as tenderly as if it were a newborn baby", "a restless sea of windows and headlights", "our hearts thudding louder than our footsteps"), gentle irony (Lin's "evidence"), and an ending that echoes an earlier detail. The narrator's view of Lin, and the change in the children, must be inferred: neither is stated.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
14	Vocabulary in context	very strong, so it is hard to argue with		
15	Explaining in your own words	**1 mark** for two reasons in the student's own words: he moved in in the middle of the night; he only goes out after dark (after sunset) and comes back at dawn, tired; he has a long black case that he carries very carefully, as if something secret is inside.	Key words from the text inside the student's own sentence ("He goes out at night and comes home in the morning"; "He has a big black case and he is very careful with it"); "nobody saw any furniture"; "he hums" (from the notebook)	One reason only; two whole sentences copied from the text ("He never left the building before sunset, and he crept home at dawn ..."); "because he is a spy"
16	Writer's viewpoint	The writer wants us to see that Lin's evidence is not really evidence: humming proves nothing, so the writer is gently making fun of Lin and her spy idea.	Her evidence is silly, funny or weak; anyone can hum; Lin thinks everything is suspicious; Lin is imagining things; the narrator does not really believe her	"Spies hum" or "Mr Gao is a spy" (takes Lin at her word: a literal reading, so note it); "humming is suspicious"
17	Inference with evidence	**1 mark** for an inference and evidence that fits it: he already knew the children had been watching or following him (and did not mind). Evidence: "The two who write everything down."	He had seen them spying; he knew about the notebook; he expected or wanted them to come, with "The two who write everything down", "Come and see what I have been hiding" or "If anything, he looked pleased"; he is friendly and wanted to share the telescope, with "he looked pleased" or "Come and see"	An inference with no evidence, or evidence that does not fit; "he was not surprised" (repeats the question); "he is a spy"
18	Inference with evidence	**1 mark** for an inference and evidence that fits it: she realised that she had been wrong about Mr Gao, and felt embarrassed or sorry that she had spied on him. Evidence: "Lin said nothing. For once, she did not write anything down either", "She did not explain", or what was in the case ("rising out of it ... was a telescope"; "Come and see what I have been hiding").	She does not think he is a spy any more; she wants to forget the spy game; she likes him now; she does not need the notes, because she knows the truth (the case held a telescope)	"Because the notebook was full"; "to throw away rubbish"; an inference with no evidence

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept
19	Effect of the writer's choice of structure	8:47 is the time in Lin's notebook when Mr Gao leaves with his case. At the end the children are waiting for him at the same time, but now to look through the telescope with him, not to spy on him. The repeated time shows how much they have changed.	It links the ending to the notebook at the start; they now want to go with him every evening; the spy game has turned into stargazing; they want to see Saturn again at the time he goes up	"Because it is in the evening"; "because he goes out then" with no sense of the change (literal: note it)
20	Summary (2)	**1 mark** for each of two stages, in order and in the student's own words, up to 2: at first they think he is a spy (Lin is sure; the narrator is not sure, but enjoys the game) and spy on him; on the roof they are surprised or amazed to find he only has a telescope, and realise they were wrong; at the end they like or admire him and want to look at the sky with him again.	Short, simple sentences; the start and the end without the middle (2 marks)	Events with no feelings ("they followed him up the stairs") score 0 for that point; whole sentences copied from the story score 0

Band guide v2 (reading paper, / 24). Use the part scores, in this order:

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A**
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B**
Part B 3 to 5	**C**
Part B 6 to 8 with Part C 0 to 4	**D**
Part B 6 to 8 with Part C 5 to 8	**E**

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example a high Part C with a low Part B, which can happen when a student ran out of time or misread one instruction), and check against the sentence reading screen in the interview.

What to look for

- Part B (Mist) is the age-level story: a fluent reader of 11 scores 6 or more. Part C is above age level; 5 or more in Part C is strong evidence of band E, and of a reader who will cope with demanding texts in English lessons.
- In Part C, strong readers explain in their own words (15 and 20), see the joke in Lin's "evidence" (16) and notice that the ending repeats 8:47 (19). Weaker readers copy sentences, or read Lin's view as the truth ("spies hum").
- A student who does Parts A and B well but leaves Part C blank may have run out of time rather than understanding. Note where they stopped at 15 minutes.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** Most students in this pack are learning English, so low scores usually reflect vocabulary. If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

The tasks

- **Task 1 (narrative):** a story that begins "When Mei opened the box, she could not believe her eyes."
- **Task 2 (opinion):** "The school summer holiday should be shorter." Do you agree?

Marking. Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task.	A short response that follows the task; ideas listed with simple links ("and", "then"); a beginning but a weak or missing ending; little paragraphing.	A complete, well-shaped story or argument for the age: an opening that sets the scene or position, ideas developed with detail or reasons and examples, a clear ending; paragraphs; the reader is kept in mind.
Vocabulary	Single memorised words or copied words.	Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese.	A wide range for the age, chosen for effect (precise verbs and adjectives, some less common words); words for linking ideas ("however", "although", "for example").
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Simple sentences, some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear.	Varied sentences, including complex ones ("When ...", "which ...", "if ..."); tenses controlled (past for the story, present for the opinion); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation.	Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly.	Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas, question marks, apostrophes and speech marks mostly correct.

Rough guide to the total (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

Band E writing at Year 7. Comparable to a fluent writer of 11 or 12. In 10 minutes, usually 150 to 250 words in clear paragraphs. The story has a real event and an ending, with some dialogue or description; the opinion gives a clear view, two or three reasons with examples, and often mentions the other side. Sentences are varied and controlled, vocabulary is chosen with care, and errors are few and minor. Some fluent writers write less in 10 minutes but very well: judge quality, not just length.

What to look for

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- A student who writes a strong plan but few lines may think well but write slowly in English: note it.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses. Writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught through grammar and textbook dialogues.

3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1 and uses **`forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`**. It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen** (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`): for Year 7, **start at Level 6 (sentence 16)**, and follow the rules on the record for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors on the interview record. Copy the sentence reading total, reading age and the speaking band into the score summary.

The interview record's opinion questions include homework and phones. These do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths pages. There are three sections. Section A is calculation and algebra. Section B is word questions: read the question, write an equation and solve it. Section C is problems with pictures, tables and charts. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 25 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not learnt the topic. Answers, reasons and explanations must be in English (numbers and working count).

What the paper is for. Version 2 is aimed at the higher end. It starts at the level expected for entry to Year 7 (the end of UK Year 6) and goes well beyond it, into Year 7 and early Year 8 content; there are no easy "floor" questions. It measures three things separately, because students from Chinese schools are usually strong in the first and less practised in the other two: **fluency** (Section A: calculation and algebra with no context), **word questions** (Section B: problems given only in sentences, which the student must read and set up) and **applied problems** (Section C: multi-step problems in real or unfamiliar contexts, with diagrams, charts and "Show" or "Explain").

Marking. Accept any clear, correct method. A correct answer scores full marks, with or without working, except where the question says **Show** or **Explain** (questions 14 and 18c) or asks for reasons (16): there the working or reason is part of the answer. In Section B, a correct answer scores 2 however it was found (an equation, a bar model, or trial and improvement with a check). Accept equivalent answers (for example 6/10 for 3/5) unless the question says otherwise. Units are printed on the paper, so a missing unit does not lose a mark. **M1** is a method mark: give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip, or for the step named, when the final answer is wrong.

Section A: Fluency (10 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	a 4 7/12 · b 3/5	1 + 1	a: 55/12, 3 19/12. 3 8/10 means the student added the numerators and the denominators. b: 0.6, 24/40, 6/10. 64/15 or 4 4/15 means the student multiplied instead of dividing.	Adding mixed numbers with different denominators (the expected level for entry); dividing mixed numbers
2	80	1	8 or 800: a place value slip.	Dividing by a decimal
3	100	1	316 means $(3 \times 6)^2$; 5.5 means the student worked from left to right ((108 – 64) ÷ 8).	Order of operations with powers and brackets
4	19	1	–1 means 5 × (–2) was taken as +10; 1 means $(-3)^2$ was taken as –9.	Negative numbers and powers
5	42	1	Usually 10% + 5% + 2.5% = 24 + 12 + 6.	Percentages of amounts
6	$2x - 15$	1	$-15 + 2x$. $2x - 5$ means only the first term was multiplied; $10x - 15$ means $4x$ was added.	Expanding a bracket and collecting like terms
7	33	1	–15 (9 – 24, a sign error in $-2ab$); 15 ($(-3)^2$ taken as –9).	Substitution with negative numbers
8	–3.5	1	–7/2, –3½, –14/4. 3.5 is a sign error; 6.5 or –6.5 means 6 was added to 20.	Solving a two-step equation with a negative answer
9	$26 - 3n$	1	$-3n + 26$. "Subtract 3" (the term-to-term rule) scores 0 but shows partial understanding: note it. $23 - 3n$ or $3n + 20$ score 0.	The nth term of a decreasing sequence

Section B: Word questions (8 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
10	11	2	**M1** for $3(n + 6) = 51$, $(n + 6) \times 3 = 51$, or $51 \div 3 = 17$ seen. 33 (from $n + 6 \times 3 = 51$) means the order in the sentences was not followed; 15 (from $3n + 6 = 51$) the same.	"I think of a number": brackets from words
11	¥2 (2.00)	2	**M1** for $3(p + 2.50) + 2p = 17.50$, or $5p + 7.50 = 17.50$, or a trial checked correctly. 4.50 (the pen, not the pencil) scores 1. 3 (from $3p + 2.50 + 2p = 17.50$, with the 2.50 counted once) and 3.50 (17.50 ÷ 5) score 0.	Costs: forming and solving an equation with decimals
12	126 (cm^2)	2	**M1** for width 9 or length 14 (from $4w + 10 = 46$ or $2(w + w + 5) = 46$). 9 or 14 as the final answer scores 1. 132.25 (treated as a square, 11.5 × 11.5) scores 0.	Perimeter with algebraic sides, then area

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
13	15	2	**M1** for $3a + 5 = 2(a + 5)$, or Aisha's age 5 seen. 5 as the final answer (Aisha's age) scores 1. 30 (from $3a = 2(a + 5)$, forgetting that Amir also gets 5 years older) scores 0.	Ages: an equation with the unknown on both sides

Section C: Applied problems (12 marks)

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
14	Carton **B** (1.2 litres)	2	**M1** for values that compare the two cartons by a correct method, for example ¥16.80 and ¥16.00 a litre; ¥1.68 and ¥1.60 for 100 ml; ¥2.52 and ¥2.40 for 150 ml; ¥50.40 and ¥48.00 for 3 litres; or ¥20.16 for 1.2 litres at Carton A's price. **A1** for correct values and B. "B" with no working, or "B because it is bigger", scores 0 (the question says Show).	Best buy: proportional reasoning with decimals and mixed units (ml and litres)
15	21 (points)	2	**M1** for 44 and 11 (the total and mean of games 1 to 4) with 13 seen, or 65 (5 × 13). 16 (60 – 44, using a mean of 12) and 13 (the new mean given as the score) score 0.	The mean with a missing value; reading a bar chart
16	$x = 65$, $y = 115$ (degrees)	3	**1** for $x = 65$. **1** for $y = 115$ (follow through: 180 – their x). **1** for a correct reason for x **and** a correct reason for y (both are needed for this mark): for x, vertically opposite angles are equal (angle AXB = 50°) or the base angles of an isosceles triangle are equal, or angles in a triangle add up to 180°; for y, angles on a straight line add up to 180°, or the exterior angle of a triangle equals the sum of the two opposite interior angles (50 + 65). Simple words are fine ("opposite angles are the same", "two equal sides so two equal angles", "a straight line is 180"). $x = 50$ (the given angle copied) scores 0.	Angle reasoning with reasons: vertically opposite angles, isosceles triangles, angles on a straight line
17	12:15	2	12:15 pm, 12.15, quarter past twelve. **M1** for 300 layers (60 ÷ 0.2), 9000 seconds, 150 minutes or 2 hours 30 minutes. 2 hours 30 minutes as the final answer scores 1. 10:00 (from 30 layers: 6 ÷ 0.2, with centimetres not changed to millimetres) scores 0.	Rates in an unfamiliar context; changing units (cm and mm, seconds, minutes and hours); time
18	a 26 · b 22 · c see the next column	1 + 1 + 1	a: 2 × 10 + 6, or counting on in twos from 8. b: 22 (22 grey tiles use 2 × 22 + 6 = 50 white tiles; 23 would need 52). 22.5 or 23 scores 0. c: any correct general reason: the number of white tiles is $2n + 6 = 2(n + 3)$, which is a multiple of 2; the white tiles are two equal rows (above and below) plus 2 at the ends; each new grey tile adds 2 white tiles, starting from 8. "8, 10 and 12 are even" (examples only) scores 0, because it does not explain why every pattern is even.	A linear pattern in context; the largest whole number that fits; explaining a general rule

Totals: Fluency (Section A) / 10 · Word questions (Section B) / 8 · Applied (Section C) / 12 · **Total / 30**.

Band guide v2 (maths, / 30; provisional, for a harder paper): 0 to 10 **1** Below expected (under 35%) · 11 to 16 **2** Working towards (35 to 54%) · 17 to 22 **3** Expected (55 to 74%) · 23 to 30 **4** Greater depth, likely top set (75% or more). List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught. These cut-offs are lower than in version 1 because the paper is harder; review them after the first 20 to 30 candidates.

Reading the three sub-scores

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency high (8 to 10), word questions low (0 to 4)	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read the word questions aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the student then solves them, record that the barrier is English.
Fluency and word questions high, applied low (under 6)	Strong calculation and setting up, less practice in multi-step problems, choosing a method and explaining.	The student needs teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. Note it for the maths teacher.
All three high (23 or more in total)	Greater depth.	Likely top set.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
Fluency low, mostly on NT topics (1b, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9)	Gaps from the different order of topics in Chinese schools.	List the NT topics and judge whether the student will reach band 3 once taught.
Fluency low on familiar topics (1a, 2)	A real gap in calculation.	Note it, with the word question and applied scores, for the maths teacher.

May not have been taught. A Year 7 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 5 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 6 or later, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

Questions	Topic	Usually taught in China
1b	Dividing fractions (adding fractions with different denominators and mixed numbers is Grade 5)	Grade 6
3	Powers such as 4^3 (squares may be familiar from area)	Grade 7
4, 7	Calculating with negative numbers	Grade 6 (meaning), Grade 7 (operations)
5	Percentages	Grade 6
6	Expanding brackets and collecting like terms	Grade 7
8	An equation with a negative answer (simple equations are Grade 5)	Grade 7
9, 18	A rule for the *n*th term (spotting patterns is common; letters for numbers is Grade 5)	Not taught formally
13	An equation with the unknown on both sides, such as $3a + 5 = 2(a + 5)$ (age problems are often solved without algebra in Chinese primary schools, and any correct method scores)	Grade 7
16	Vertically opposite angles (isosceles triangles, the angle sum of a triangle and angles on a straight line are Grade 4)	Grade 7

Usually **familiar**: decimals, including dividing by a decimal (Grade 5); adding and subtracting fractions (Grade 5); solving word problems with an equation (Grade 5, and often practised a lot in Chinese, so Section B mainly tests whether the student can read the problem in English); unit prices; the mean (Grade 4); perimeter and area (Grade 3); 24-hour time (Grade 3).

What to look for

- **Compare the three sub-scores** (table above) before deciding that a student is weak at maths.
- In Section B, a student who writes a correct equation but makes a slip has understood the English. A student who leaves the section blank, or combines the numbers in the order they appear (for example 6 × 3 + 51), has probably been stopped by the English: read the question aloud and see.
- Questions 14, 16 and 18c ask the student to show, give reasons or explain. Many students from Chinese schools give correct answers without reasons. A correct number with no reason gets the answer marks only. That is useful information for teachers, not a sign of weak maths.
- Strong students get 3, 8, 9, 13, 15, 17 and 18b, and give general reasons in 18c. Question 17 is an unfamiliar context: a student who changes 6 cm to 60 mm without being told is reading the problem carefully.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science pages. There are 6 questions. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable (for example "ginko", "oxigen").

Q	Answer	Marks	Accept, partial credit and common errors	Content
1	A ginkgo · B maple · C lotus	2	**2** for all three; **1** for two. Uses a key (working scientifically).	Classification keys
2	oxygen	1	Carbon dioxide is a common confusion (it is given out in the lungs).	The heart and blood
3	a 130 · b His muscles need more oxygen (or energy), so the heart pumps blood faster to carry it to them.	1 + 1	a: reading a graph between labelled gridlines. b: accept "his body needs more oxygen", "to get more energy to the muscles", "more blood goes to the muscles". Not: "because he is tired", "because running is hard".	Exercise and health; reading a graph
4	a bulb, switch, cell (left to right) · b **B**	1 + 1	a: all three for the mark. b: C (two bulbs) means the student thinks more bulbs give more light.	Circuit symbols; more cells and brighter bulbs
5	a the puppet she uses · b smaller	1 + 1	b: shorter, small, lower, less tall. "Bigger" means the table was read the wrong way.	Light and shadows; fair tests and variables; reading a table
6	The rocks were once under the sea.	1	The land or mountain was once the sea bed; the sea was there long ago; the rocks moved up from the sea. Not: "the animals climbed up", "a bird carried them".	Fossils and evolution

Band guide (science, / 10; provisional): 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

May not have been taught. Primary science (科学) in China covers these areas but the textbooks differ, so a Year 7 entrant **may not have been taught**: dichotomous keys (Q1; sorting living things is usually familiar), the heart and circulation in detail (Q2, Q3b; this comes fully in Grade 7 biology), circuit symbols (Q4a; circuits are Grade 4, often with drawings rather than symbols), and fossils and evolution (Q6). Light and shadows (Q5) are usually taught in Grade 5.

What to look for

- Questions 1, 3 and 5 test working scientifically (using a key, reading a graph and a table, fair tests). A student who does these well thinks scientifically even if the topic knowledge is NT.
- Short or one-word answers are fine. Answers must be in English; an explanation in Chinese scores 0.

6. Score summary

Candidate name	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Part	Score	Band	Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour)
Listening	/ 16 (Part A / 8, Part B / 8)	A B C D E	
Reading paper	/ 24 (A / 8, B / 8, C / 8)	A B C D E	Where did the student stop at 15 minutes?
Sentence reading (shared record)	points / 72, reading age	indicative A B C D E	Meaning checks, fluency
Writing	/ 16 (content / 4, vocabulary / 4, grammar / 4, spelling and punctuation / 4)	A B C D E	Task chosen: 1 2
Speaking (from the interview)		A B C D E	
Maths	/ 30 (Fluency / 10, Word questions / 8, Applied / 12)	1 2 3 4	NT: L:
Science	/ 10	1 2 3 4	NT: L:

Maths profile: Fluency ___ / 10 (___ %), word questions ___ / 8 (___ %), applied ___ / 12 (___ %). If the word question percentage is much lower than fluency, was the barrier English? (Tick if a word question was solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.) ☐ If applied is much lower than both, the student needs teaching in problem solving and explaining. ☐

Overall English band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** (the band most of the four skills sit in; name any skill that is two or more bands below the others)

Comments (strengths, gaps, NT topics, what support the student would need):

Assessor signature and date _____

Copy these results onto `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: assessor record

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Age today (years:months)	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Assessor	

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this record, a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening).

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"

Code	Error	Example
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (mark them, but do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said in the notes. Patterns in the notes (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in the record). Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Record ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood). The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is recorded ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Record

Level 1 (sentences 1 to 3)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
1	I can see a red bus.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
2	The cat sat on my bed.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
3	Dad has a big hat.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 2 (sentences 4 to 6)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
6	They like to play in the park.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 3 (sentences 7 to 9)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 4 (sentences 10 to 12)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 5 (sentences 13 to 15)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 6 (sentences 16 to 18)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 7 (sentences 19 to 21)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 8 (sentences 22 to 24)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 9 (sentences 25 to 27)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 10 (sentences 28 to 30)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 11 (sentences 31 to 33)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

Level 12 (sentences 34 to 36)

No.	Sentence	Points	Errors and notes
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.	☐2 ☐1 ☐0	
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*	☐✓ ☐½ ☐✗	
	Level total	/ 6	

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Total points	/ 72
Reading age	
Actual age (years:months)	
Difference (reading age minus actual age)	
Meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓)	
Fluency rating (1 to 4)	
Patterns noticed	

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and

structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Copy to the Candidate Summary: total points, reading age, actual age, meaning checks, fluency, indicative band, one line on patterns.

Student interview and suitability record: Years 7 to 10

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Interviewer	
Others present (for example receiving homeroom teacher; Chinese-speaking colleague)	

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; record on `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record.md`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Sentence reading (3 to 5 minutes)

Total points ___ / 72 Reading age _____ Meaning checks ___ Fluency ___ (details on the sentence reading record)

2. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. Tick the ones you used and write short notes: what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?	
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?	
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?	
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.	
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?	
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?	
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?	

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch	Notes
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?	
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?	
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?	
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?	
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?	
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?	
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?	
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?	
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?	
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?	
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?	
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.	
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?	
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?	
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?	
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?		

3. Speaking band

Circle the band that fits best. Use the evidence from the whole interview.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

Speaking band: **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** Listening in conversation (how much of your English they understood): **A** **B** **C** **D** **E**

Notes on pronunciation and intelligibility (pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand):

4. Suitability

Rate each strand from what you saw and heard. **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like	Rating	Evidence
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rating ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 Evidence:

5. Anything to follow up

Area	Tick	Notes
Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)	☐	
Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)	☐	
Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)	☐	
Medical or dietary	☐	
Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans	☐	

6. Receiving homeroom teacher (optional)

If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning).

Interviewer signature and date

Parent conversation record

Candidate name	
Year group applied for	
Date	
Staff member	
Parents or carers present	
Language used (and interpreter if any)	

About 15 minutes. Hold it while the student does the written tasks with another adult, or straight after. Use the family's preferred language; a Chinese-speaking colleague should lead or interpret if the staff member does not speak Chinese. The aim is a two-way conversation: to understand the child and the family's hopes, to explain how the international programme works, and to check that what the family wants matches what the school offers. Do not discuss the assessment results on the day.

1. Why the international programme?

Question	Notes
Why are you looking for a place in the international programme, and why now?	
What do you know about how the programme works (lessons in English, the UK-style curriculum, assessment, homework, activities)?	
Whose idea is the move, and how does your child feel about it?	

2. Schooling so far

Question	Notes
Schools attended, years, and type (Chinese mainstream, bilingual, international, overseas)	
Any year repeated or skipped? Any long gaps?	
Why is the child leaving their current school?	
Student registration (学籍): where is it held now, and what will happen to it? (admissions office to give the school's position)	
School reports, certificates and any assessments the family can share	

3. Languages

Question	Notes
Which languages are spoken at home, and by whom?	
How has the child learnt English so far (school lessons from which grade, classes outside school, tutor, online, time abroad, English-speaking carer)? About how many hours a week?	
Does the child read in English at home? In Chinese?	
How will the family support English at home (reading, media, activities), and support Chinese if that matters to the family?	

4. Learning, health and development

Ask gently and explain why: the school wants to have the right support ready from the first day.

Question	Notes
What is your child good at? What do they enjoy most?	
Has any teacher or doctor ever raised a concern about learning, speech and language, attention, behaviour, hearing or vision? Any assessments or reports?	
Any extra help at the current school?	
Medical conditions, allergies, medication (also on the school medical form)	
For young children: speech in Chinese for their age, toilet and self-care, sleep	

5. Wellbeing and the week

Question	Notes
How would you describe your child's personality? How do they cope with change?	
Friendships: does your child make friends easily?	
A typical weekday and weekend: after-school classes, tutoring, sport, music, screen time, sleep	
Any big changes in the family recently (a move, a new baby, a parent working away)? Share only what you are comfortable sharing.	

6. Expectations and partnership

Question	Notes
What would make this a successful first year for your child?	
What do you expect from the school (homework, reports, communication, class rankings, exam results)? Explain how the school reports progress and how it communicates.	
How does the family feel about co-curricular activities, sport, arts, service and wellbeing as part of education, not just exam subjects?	
Learning in a new language takes time: explain what is typical (social English often within one to two years; the English needed for academic work often takes several years) and how the school supports it. How does the family feel about this?	
How would the family like to be involved (events, meetings, volunteering)?	

7. Future plans

Question	Notes
What are your hopes for your child in the long term (university, country, career)?	
Do you plan to stay in the international programme through to the end of school?	
Explain the programme's pathway (for example IGCSE, then the sixth form programme) and how it differs from the 中考 and 高考 route, using the admissions office's wording. Does the family understand that moving back to the national exam route later may not be straightforward?	
Year 10 applicants: which IGCSE subjects does the student hope to take? Explain that IGCSE is a two-year course starting in Year 10.	

8. Boarding (only if the child will board)

Question	Notes
Has the child stayed away from home before (camps, boarding, family)? How did it go?	
How independent are they with daily routines, sleep and belongings?	
How will the family keep in touch, and how often will the child go home?	

9. Questions from the family

10. Staff view

	Rating	Notes
Match between the family's expectations and what the programme offers	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Family's willingness to work in partnership with the school	☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4	
Information to follow up (reports, medical, assessments, 学籍)		

1 Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong.

Consent. The parent or carer agrees that the school may contact the current school (homeroom teacher) for a reference: **Yes** ☐ **No** ☐

Parent or carer signature _____

Staff signature and date _____

Candidate summary and decision

Candidate name	
Date of birth	
Year group applied for	
Current school	
Date of assessment	
Assessor	

Complete within two working days, from the assessor booklet, reading records, interview record, parent conversation and homeroom teacher reference. The bands guide a professional decision; they are not a pass mark (guide, Sections 6 to 9).

1. English profile

Skill	Evidence (scores)	Band
Listening	Listening task ___ / ___ ; listening in conversation	**A B C D E**
Speaking	Interview (and picture talk, Years 1 to 3)	**A B C D E**
Reading	Years 1 to 3: Early Reading Screen book band _____ accuracy ___% questions ___ ; phonics words ___ / 40 ; letter sounds ___ / 26 and ___ / 18 ; tricky words ___ / 20. Years 4 to 10: reading paper ___ / 24 (A ___ B ___ C ___)	**A B C D E**
Reading aloud	Sentence reading: points ___ / 72 ; reading age _____ ; actual age _____ ; meaning checks ___ ; fluency ___	indicative **A B C D E**
Writing	Writing task ___ / 16	**A B C D E**
Overall English	The band most of the four skills sit in. If one skill is two or more bands below the others, say which.	**A B C D E**

A New to English, **B** Early acquisition, **C** Developing competence, **D** Competent, **E** Fluent (comparable to a fluent English speaker of the same age).

2. Maths and science

	Score	Band	Number problems (Years 7 to 10 v2: fluency)	Word problems (v2: word questions)	Applied (v2 only)	Not yet taught (NT)	Language support (L)
Maths	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**	___ / ___	___ / ___	___ / 12		
Science (Years 5 to 10)	___ / ___	**1 2 3 4**					

1 Well below expected (Years 7 to 10 v2: below expected), **2** Working towards, **3** Expected, **4** Greater depth. The v2 papers are harder, so their band boundaries are lower (guide and booklets). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty. In the Years 7 to 10 v2 papers, a student strong in fluency and word questions but weak in applied problems needs teaching in problem solving, not more content. Questions marked NT score 0; say whether the student is likely to reach the expected band once taught.

Year 10 only: readiness for IGCSE (Year 10 assessor booklet, Section 6). English course: ☐ First Language ☐ English as a Second Language ☐ to decide. Maths tier: ☐ Extended ☐ Core ☐ to decide. Overall: ☐ Ready ☐ Ready with support ☐ Not yet.

Assessor's comment on maths and science (strengths, gaps, NT topics, English barrier or not):

3. Suitability

Source	Summary	Concerns (any strand rated 1)
Student interview (strands rated 1 to 4)		
Parent conversation (match of expectations, partnership)		
Previous homeroom teacher reference		
School reports and documents		
Follow-ups (special educational needs, wellbeing, medical, safeguarding referral made)		

4. Recommendation

Use the decision guide in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 9. Tick one.

	Recommendation
☐	**Offer.** Ready to join the year group with normal class support.
☐	**Offer with English support.** Ready academically; needs a planned English programme (state the level below).
☐	**Offer with a learning plan.** Needs catch-up in named maths or science topics, or other planned support; review date set.
☐	**Further assessment before a decision.** For example a second visit, a trial day, a specialist assessment, or more information from the family or school.
☐	**Unable to offer at this time.** The programme cannot meet the student's needs now. Give the reason and, where possible, what would change the decision.

Year group confirmed: _____ (by age: yes / no; if no, give the reason and who approved it)

5. Support from the first day (if offered)

Area	Plan
English support level	☐ Intensive (new to English) ☐ Timetabled support lessons ☐ In-class support and monitoring ☐ None needed
Maths and science catch-up	
Reading (book band or reading age to start from)	
Pastoral (buddy, homeroom check-ins, boarding support)	
Information for the homeroom teacher	
Review date (for example after six weeks)	

6. Sign-off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Assessor			
Head of section			
Admissions			
Outcome told to the family (start with the child's strengths)			